

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 8 3
 ♥ J 10 8 5
 ♦ K J
 ♣ Q 9 8 3

♠ A K 5

♥ A K 6

♦ 7 6 3

♣ A K 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10 7 2

♥ Q 9 4

♦ Q 10 9

♣ J 10 7

♠ 9 6 4

♥ 7 3 2

♦ A 8 5 4 2

♣ 6 5

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♠ 2

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♠ 2, West plays the ♠ J.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 7

You need two more winners and dummy's ♦ suit is your only hope. **IF** ♦ s split 3-2 and **IF** the defenders don't take too many winners in their suit(s) you can establish ♦ s by ducking twice.

Win the first ♠. If you hold up they might pocket the ♠ trick and switch to another suit where you only have two stoppers.

Next play a small ♦ from each hand. Win the return (probably a ♠) and duck a second ♦.

If the defenders can only take 2 ♠ tricks now you are home-free since dummy's 3 ♦ s are now established.

You had to have the defender's ♠ s split 4-3. But in fact you were pretty sure they were going to do so. Since East's ♠ 2 was probably his fourth-down then he couldn't have a fifth-down.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 7 4
 ♥ K 10 9 8 3
 ♦ J 5 3
 ♣ Q 3

♠ J 9 8
 ♥ A 6 5
 ♦ Q 10 9 6
 ♣ K 9 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 6 3
 ♥ Q J
 ♦ A K 4 2
 ♣ A 10 6 4

♠ Q 10 5 2
 ♥ 7 4 2
 ♦ 8 7
 ♣ J 8 7 2

West	North	East	South
		1NT	Pass
2♦	Pass	2♥	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			
Lead: ♠2			

West's 3♦ bid was a transfer to ♥s. East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♠2.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=0 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 5

Obviously you need to establish 4 ♥ winners and by driving out the ♥A you can manage that handily. The problem is that dummy has only one sure entry, (the ♠A), and the defenders may be good enough to hold up their ♥A twice.

To assure the contract you should win the first trick in your hand with the ♠K. Then play ♥Q, ♥J overtaking with dummy's ♥K so you can continue establishing the suit while you still have that ♠ entry.

None of the other suits were sitting well so overtaking the ♥ was the way to go.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 3
 ♥ K Q J 8 4
 ♦ 10 8 7 5
 ♣ J 8

♠ A J 6 4

♥ 7 5

♦ 6 3

♣ A K 6 4 3



♠ —

♥ 10 9 6 3

♦ K Q J 9 4

♣ Q 10 9 7

♠ K Q 9 8 7 5 2

♥ A 2

♦ A 2

♣ 5 2

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♥	Pass	6 ♠
All Pass			

6 ♠ by South

Lead: ♥K

South is to play 6 ♠. West leads the ♥K.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=1 ♣=0 Total = 2

One of the two red losers must be discarded on dummy's ♣ suit. So you pull trumps, taking two rounds, with ♠K and ♠Q. Then play two top ♣s and ruff a ♣. When West shows out on the third ♣, enter dummy with a trump and ruff another ♣. Dummy's final ♣ is now established, so enter dummy with another trump and discard one of the red losers on the fifth ♣.

As long as the ♣s were no worse than 4-2 you can establish the suit.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q J 5
♥ K 5 4 3
♦ A 4 3
♣ A K 5

♠ K 6 4 3

♥ 9 7

♦ K 10 8 6 2

♣ 8 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 9 7 2

♥ A J 6

♦ 7 5

♣ Q 6 4 3

♠ A 8

♥ Q 10 8 2

♦ Q J 9

♣ J 10 9 7

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
1NT			
All Pass			
1NT by West			
Lead: ♦ 6			

wins. He takes his 2 ♦ s but you are now home free. When you gain the lead again you will get your ♠ winner established and only lose 2 ♠ s and 4 ♦ s.

If you finessed the ♥ you would have gone down with the defenders winning 4 ♦ s, 1 ♥ and 2 ♠ s.

If you had played 3 rounds of ♣ s you would have gone down with the defenders winning 4 ♦ s, 1 ♣ and 2 ♠ s.

Only by establishing ♠ s can you make the contract.

West is to play 1NT. North leads the ♦ 6, taken by South with the ♦ J. South next plays the ♦ Q on which North plays the ♦ 2. South plays the ♦ 9 which you finally win.

Winners: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 6

You only need one more winner and you have several possibilities. The ♥ finesse might work, or the ♣ s might split 3-3. But you need to consider the defenders winners also. They have already scored 2 ♦ tricks and will get 2 more as soon as they gain the lead. (The spot cards told you that North has a 5-card ♦ suit.) Plus they have the 2 top ♠ s which they can take whenever they like. So if your play sets up just one more trick for them you will go down.

No, you must establish ♠ s, the suit where they have 2 winners anyway. So you play a ♠ which North